

Adrian Sauter

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First-year PhD student, working on AI Safety and Cognitively Inspired ML under the supervision of Dr. Eric Schulz at the Human-Centered AI group at Helmholtz Munich. I combine a strong academic background with industry experience, interdisciplinary thinking, and clear communication to uncover and bridge the gap between.

EDUCATION

Helmholtz Institute for Human-Centered AI

PhD in AI Safety

Munich, Germany

05/2026 – Present

- Supervisor: Dr. Eric Schulz (Helmholtz Munich)

University of Amsterdam

MSc in Artificial Intelligence (cum laude)

Amsterdam, Netherlands

09/2023 – 05/2026

- **Thesis:** Contextual Sensitivity of Moral Beliefs in Large Language Models

University of Tuebingen

BSc in Cognitive Science

Tuebingen, Germany

10/2019 – 07/2023

- **Thesis:** Video Background Extraction with a Masked-Autoencoder-Based Neural Network (Grade: 1.0)

EXPERIENCE

KPN Amsterdam

Research & Development Intern for XAI

Amsterdam, Netherlands

02/2025 – 08/2025

- Researched Explainable AI for Customer Call Classification through Concept-Bottleneck Models using LLMs.

University of Amsterdam

Teaching Assistant

Amsterdam, Netherlands

09/2024 – 02/2026

- Led tutorials and seminars for graduate courses, instructing and supervising 30-200 students.

ELLIS Unit Amsterdam

Project Assistant

Amsterdam, Netherlands

04/2024 – 08/2024

- Contributed to the planning and communication of projects that are supported and organized by ELLIS.

Neuro-Cognitive Modeling Group

Research Assistant

Tuebingen, Germany

03/2023 – 08/2023

- Provided technical consultancy for professors associated with the lab, graded assignments.

Leibnitz-Institute for Knowledge Media Research

Research Assistant

Tuebingen, Germany

12/2021 – 10/2022

- Supervised in-person psychological experiments and helped analyzing the obtained data.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Sauter, A.**, Pemmasani Prabakaran, R.S., Miletić, M., & Ott, R. (2024). "Studying How to Efficiently and Effectively Guide Models with Explanations" - A Reproducibility Study. **Transactions on Machine Learning Research**.
- Traub, M., Becker, F., **Sauter, A.**, Otte, S., & Butz, M. (2024). Loci-segmented: improving scene segmentation learning. In **International Conference on Artificial Neural Networks** (pp. 45–61).
- **Sauter, A.**, Zuidema, W., & Kloots, M. D. H. (2025). The Curious Case of Visual Grounding: Different Effects for Speech-and Text-based Language Encoders. arXiv preprint arXiv:2509.15837. **ICASSP 2026**.
- **Sauter, A.**, Neplenbroek, V., Vlassopoulos, G., & Bardelloni, G. Actionable Interpretability for Churn Classification: A Text Bottleneck Model Case Study at a Major Telecom Provider. In **The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics--Industry Track**.